

Lesson 4: Tell Your Story Professionally

What You're Doing Today

You've got a portfolio site started (Lesson 3) and a direction for what kind of projects to build (Lesson 2). Today you write the words that go on that site: a short bio that introduces you, and your first project case study — a short write-up that proves you can actually do the thing, not just that you're interested in it.

Why This Matters

Anyone can write "I love coding and I'm a fast learner." That sentence tells a reader nothing, because it could be true of literally anyone and can't be checked. What actually convinces someone you can build things is specific, honest description of what you've built. This lesson teaches you a formula for both your bio and your case study so you never have to guess what to write — you fill in real facts about real work.

The voice you're aiming for isn't stiff or corporate ("the candidate possesses strong technical acumen") and it isn't hollow cheerleading ("I am SO passionate about tech!!"). It's just clear and true: what you build, in plain language.

The Bio Formula

A strong short bio has four parts:

1. **Who you are** — your name, and one honest identifier (student, age/grade optional, what you're focused on).
2. **What you build** — the actual kind of things you make, named specifically (not "cool stuff," but "web pages," "small games," "apps that use APIs").
3. **What you're working toward** — a real current goal or skill you're building next.
4. **One proof point** — something a reader can check: a link to your portfolio, a specific project name, a specific tool you've used.

You don't need all four in every version — see the three length variants in your worksheet — but a full bio should hit all four.

The Case Study Formula

For each project, use this five-part structure:

Section	What goes here
Project	Name of the project and one line on what it is.

Section	What goes here
Problem	What need, question, or goal started the project.
My Approach	What you actually did — tools used, decisions made, steps taken.
Result	What actually happened. Working or partly working — say which.
What I Learned	One real thing you now know that you didn't before.

A case study is not a diary entry and not a sales pitch. It's a short, structured, honest account.

Worked Example (Fictional Student: Jordan R.)

Bio (paragraph version):

I'm Jordan, a high school student who builds small web tools — mostly HTML/CSS sites and simple JavaScript apps. My latest project is a habit tracker that saves data in the browser so it remembers your streaks. Right now I'm learning how to connect my sites to real APIs. You can see my work at jordanbuilds.dev.

Case Study:

Section	Jordan's Answer
Project	Habit Tracker — a browser-based app that lets a user log daily habits and see a streak count.
Problem	I wanted a simple way to track a daily habit (drinking water) but didn't want to use someone else's app — I wanted to understand how the logic worked.
My Approach	Built the interface in HTML/CSS, used JavaScript to store entries in the browser's localStorage so data persists after refresh, and added a streak counter that checks consecutive days.
Result	It works and saves data correctly between sessions. It doesn't yet work across devices — it's tied to one browser, which I know is a limitation.
What I Learned	I learned how localStorage works and why apps that need to sync across devices need a real backend/database, which I don't have yet. That's my next thing to learn.

Notice: nothing here is exaggerated, nothing is invented, and the limitation ("doesn't work across devices") makes it more credible, not less.

Step-by-Step Activity

1. Open your Worksheet (bio + case study templates).
2. Write your 1-sentence bio first. Then expand it into the 2–3 sentence version, then the paragraph version.
3. Pick ONE real, completed Lumexa or personal project.
4. Fill in the case study template for that project, section by section — don't skip any.

5. Read both pieces aloud to yourself. Cross out any word that could apply to literally any student ("passionate," "hardworking," "amazing") unless a specific fact follows it.
6. Save your drafts — you'll wire them into your actual portfolio page in Lesson 6, and you'll reuse this exact case-study template for your next project.

Key Terms

- **Bio** — a short written introduction of yourself, used on a portfolio, resume, or profile.
- **Case study** — a structured write-up of one project, describing the problem, process, and outcome.
- **Proof point** — a specific, checkable fact (a link, a named project, a named tool) that backs up a claim.
- **Jargon/buzzword** — a vague, often-overused word ("synergy," "passionate," "detail-oriented") that sounds impressive but carries no specific information.
- **Voice** — the tone and style of your writing; this lesson's target voice is clear, honest, and plain.

Knowledge Checks

1. What are the four parts of the bio formula?
2. What are the five sections of the case study template, in order?
3. Why is "I'm passionate about coding" considered weak writing in this lesson, even though it might be true?
4. If a project didn't fully work, should you leave it out of your case study? Why or why not?
5. Give one example of a buzzword and rewrite it as a specific, factual sentence.

Reflection Prompts

1. Which was harder to write honestly — your bio or your case study — and why?
2. Read your first draft bio back. What's one sentence you removed or changed because it sounded generic, and what did you replace it with?
3. What's one real thing your case study project taught you that you didn't expect to learn when you started it?

Submission Instructions

Save your completed Worksheet (bio, all three length versions, and one full case study) to your course folder in Google Docs, named [LastName_Lesson4_Bio_CaseStudy](#) . Share it with your instructor for feedback before Lesson 6, where you'll refine this case study and add a second one.